

begins the extensive ספר of קרבנות. Before we even start, I always like to point out when we reach ויקרא how interesting and, from our vantage point, complicated the קרבנות are. To many of us, particularly those who are not well-versed in both הלכה and השקפה, ספר ויקרא may seem not to be that relevant. However, not only despite that but specifically because of that, R' Samson Raphael Hirsch devotes six ספרים of חלקים to חמשה חומשי תורה, and the one that has double the amount of ספרים is ספר ויקרא. I always emphasize this point because it demonstrates that every פרט in ויקרא contains a world of learning and a world of תורה.

אדם Why is the word אדם included? פסוק ב' says in The word אדם could not bring a קרבן from stolen property (as he owned everything), so too, you are not allowed to steal an animal and offer it as a קרבן; it must be your own.

The ספר אפריון, written by a tremendous גאון - ר' שלמה גנצפריד זצ"ל, offers an additional perspective. The ספר could have simply said: דבר אל בני ישראל ואמרם אליהם כי יקריב מכם קרבן לה'. What is the word אדם coming to teach us that we would not have otherwise known?

The אפריון presents a fascinating insight involving many גמטריות and deep mathematical concepts. I will try my best to do justice to it, and if I do not succeed, it is not the אפריון's fault, but mine. He quotes ספר "The Bounty of Dew." He brings it down in the name of מקובלים, so we immediately know that this is a קבלה-based idea rather than a simple פשט. His name consists of מצוות עשה and through His מעשים, is understood through His מצוות עשה. His name consists of 613 מצוות, broken into 248 positive מצוות and 365 negative מצוות. What is the רמז for this? The שמות ג' ט"ו in פסוק states: זֶה שְׁמִי לְעֹלָם וְזֶה זִכְרִי לְדֹר דֹּר. If you take the גמטריה of the word שמי along with the first half of Hashem's name - ה', ו', ה' - it equals 365, the number of מצוות עשה. Similarly, if you take the גמטריה of the word זכרי along with the second half of Hashem's name - ה', ו', ה' - it equals 248, the number of מצוות לא תעשה. Thus, the two halves of Hashem's name, together with this פסוק - זֶה שְׁמִי וְזֶה זִכְרִי - correspond precisely to the מצוות עשה and the מצוות לא תעשה that we fulfill.

Now, all of the נשמות from the beginning of time until משיח comes - all of ישראל - are a חלק ממעל. We know that our נשמות come from Himself, as the פסוק states: ה' עִמּוֹ דְּבָרִים ל"ב:ט' in פסוק. That חלק - the portion of Hashem - is our נשמות. The אפריון brings another fascinating principle: when you have a חלק (a portion) of something, it is exactly the same as the original. A sample of something is identical to the whole. In Hebrew: There is no difference between the חלק and the actual item itself. Since we are a חלק ה', that means we are דומה to the whole. What part of us reflects this? The inner אור, the light of our נשמה, which is infinite and has no גשמייות whatsoever. Our נשמה is a חלק ממעל - a spark of חלק אלוהים - given to us as a זכות, a part of Himself. This נשמה is connected to the מצוות תרי"ג, and is equivalent to Hashem's name. How so?

We mention this concept many times in our תפילות, specifically in various יוצרות, and most notably during תשליך. In some מהזורים, it is only written as an abbreviation, but in the larger מהזורים, including Artscroll, it is fully spelled out: נפש, רוח, נשמה. These three words contain a tremendous depth of תורה. There is a vast amount of discussion, especially from the הלוי, about the significance of נפש, רוח, and נשמה - how each one corresponds to different aspects of our existence and our connection to חלק אלוהים. The אפריון points out that the ראשי תיבות and סוף תיבות of these three words - נשמה, רוח, נפש - equal תרי"ג. If you calculate: נ' + ר' + ו' (the first letters) = 300, and ה' + ח' + ש' (the last letters) = 313. Together, they total תרי"ג. This תרי"ג represents both our spiritual and physical being, which are rooted in the רמ"ה ושס"ה - the לבוש, a גוף - our גידים and אברים - are merely a חלק ממעל.



סכך, for the נשמה. The פסוק in י"א describes this: The vital component of אדם consists of the מצוות תרי"ג, which is precisely the same as the name of הוא, which expresses His essence. So we see demonstrated that a חלק of something is exactly the same as the original. אדם is a חלק אלוך ממעל. Since Hashem's name with זכר וזה שמי totals תרי"ג, therefore אדם, made up of רוח, נפש, and נשמה, also totals תרי"ג.

Now, in פסוק ג of our פרשה, there is another difficult word: אם עלה קרבנו מן הבקר זכר תמים יקריבנו אל פתח אהל. The difficult word here is לרצנו - what does that mean? When a person brings a קרבן, it has to be לרצנו, meaning he must want to do it. But the question is, if the person doesn't want to bring the קרבן, why is he bringing it?

The אפריון brings down a famous rule: if there is a מצוה that a person is מחויב to do but refuses, we say כופין אותו עד שיאמר רוצה אני. The question is, how does this work? If someone is coerced, if he is forced until he says רוצה אני, how can that be considered רצון? This question is discussed by many מפרשים, including R' Samson Raphael Hirsch, the אפריון, and the בית הלוי.

The answer is that a person, in his essence, truly wants to do a מצוה. However, his יצר הרע gets in the way - what Chazal call the שבעיסה. Whether it is personal desires, distractions, or irrelevant wants, these influences convince him not to fulfill the מצוה. But what is the person's true essence? His true essence is that he really does want to do it. Therefore, we say כופין אותו עד שיאמר רוצה אני - forcing him to verbalize his רצון is not creating an artificial desire but rather removing the external barriers that obscure his true רצון.

This, says the אפריון, is the meaning of לרצנו. When we bring a קרבן, we are demonstrating our deepest רצון - to do the השם. As it says in (ב'ד') פרקי אבות: רצון השם. A קרבן is not just about bringing an animal to the בית המקדש; it is a representation of our innermost feelings, our deepest aspirations, and our essence. A person is defined by what he desires and does, especially when it comes to doing the השם.

The אפריון emphasizes that the נשמה, which is called אדם, is a חלק אלוך ממעל. This is what defines אדם - the real אדם is one who strives to fulfill all of the מצוות תרי"ג. אדם connects to אדם העליון, and the word אדם represents our גשמיים, our highest ideals. A true אדם is one who recognizes that his גשמיים is merely a covering for his נשמה. When the פסוק states: אָדָם כִּי יִקְרִיב מִכֶּם, it means that by bringing a קרבן, we demonstrate our inner essence. We are not just people with desires and needs. The famous question: "Do you eat to live, or do you live to eat?" speaks to this. Our purpose is not to simply fulfill our physical needs; it is to fulfill our תפקיד as נשמות. This is what אדם truly means: one who translates his physical existence into doing the השם.

